Prof. Dr. Samuel Muehlemann

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Curriculum Vitae — October 2026

Research Interests: Personnel Economics, Economics of Education, Labor Economics

Academic Positions

LMU Munich School of Management, Munich, Germany 2014 –
Professor of Human Resource Education and Development

University of Zurich, Faculty of Business, Economics and Informatics, Switzerland 2015 –
Guest Lecturer (Master's program; PhD program for Swiss Leading House VPET-ECON)

University of Bern, Centre for Research in Economics of Education, Switzerland 2009 – 2014
Senior Research Associate (2009–2011), Deputy Head (2011–2014)

Visiting Positions

University of California, Berkeley, IRLE, USA 2013 – 2014
Visiting Scholar

King's College London, Department of Management, UK 2009
Visiting Academic

Fellowships and Committee Memberships

- Federal Institute for Vocational Education and Training (BIBB), Research Fellow 2022 –
- ROA, Maastricht University, Research Fellow 2022 –
- IZA@LISER Network (formerly IZA Institute of Labor Economics), Research Fellow 2012 –
- European Expert Network on Economics of Education (EENEE), Member 2021 – 2024
- Expert Network on Economics and Sociology of Education and Training (ENESET), Member 2025 –
- Swiss National Science Foundation, Steering Committee Member NRP 77 Digital Transformation 2020 – 2024
- German Economic Association (VfS), Research Committee Economics of Education 2012 –
- Federal Commission for Child and Youth Affairs (EKKJ), Member 2012 – 2014

Editorial Board Membership

- Editorial Advisory Board, *Empirical Research in Vocational Education and Training* (ERVET), Springer 2018 –

Education

University of Bern, Dr. rer. oec. (Economics), *summa cum laude* 2008
University of Bern, Lic. rer. pol. (Economics and Management) 2004

University of British Columbia, Visiting Student (Honours Economics) 2000 – 2001

Publications in Refereed Journals

Gholami, M., & Muehlemann, S. (2026). Do soft-skills courses pay for individuals? Evidence from German matched data. *Empirical Research in Vocational Education and Training*, *18*(1), Article 9. https://doi.org/10.1186/s40461-026-00210-1

Linckh, C., Muehlemann, S., & Pfeifer, H. (2026). Beggars cannot be choosers: Labor market tightness, hiring standards, wages, and hiring costs. *Labour Economics*, *102*, 102941. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.labeco.2026.102941

Gholami, M., & Muehlemann, S. (2026). Pathways to prosperity: The role of cognitive and non-cognitive skills in employer quality and early career earnings. *Education Economics*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1080/09645292.2026.2664425

Weis, K., Muehlemann, S., & Pfeifer, H. (2026). Works councils and apprenticeship training: Heterogeneous works councils, heterogeneous effects? *British Journal of Industrial Relations*, *64*(2), 250–262. https://doi.org/10.1111/bjir.70030

Muehlemann, S. (2025). Artificial intelligence adoption and workplace training. *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, *238*, 107206.

Muehlemann, S., Dietrich, H., Pfann, G., & Pfeifer, H. (2022). Shocks in the market for apprenticeship training. *Economics of Education Review*, *86*, 102197.

Muehlemann, S., Pfeifer, H., & Wittek, B. (2020). The effect of business cycle expectations on the German apprenticeship market: Estimating the impact of Covid-19. *Empirical Research in Vocational Education and Training*, *12*(1), 1–30.

Moretti, L., Mayerl, M., Muehlemann, S., Schlögl, P., & Wolter, S. C. (2019). So similar and yet so different: A firm's net costs and post-training benefits from apprenticeship training in Austria and Switzerland. *Evidence-based HRM*, *7*(2), 229–246.

Koch, B., Muehlemann, S., & Pfeifer, H. (2019). Do works councils improve the quality of apprenticeship training? Evidence from German workplace data. *Journal of Participation and Employee Ownership*, *2*(1), 47–59.

Muehlemann, S., & Strupler Leiser, M. (2018). Hiring costs and labor market tightness. *Labour Economics*, *52*, 122–131.

Wenzelmann, F., Muehlemann, S., & Pfeifer, H. (2017). The costs of recruiting apprentices: Evidence from German workplace-level data. *German Journal of Human Resource Management*, *31*(2), 108–131.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2017). Can Spanish firms offer dual apprenticeships without making a net investment? *Evidence-based HRM*, *5*(1), 107–118.

Muehlemann, S., & Pfeifer, H. (2016). The structure of hiring costs in Germany. *Industrial Relations*, *55*(2), 193–218.

Blatter, M., Muehlemann, S., Schenker, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2016). Hiring costs for skilled workers and the supply of firm-provided training. *Oxford Economic Papers*, *68*(1), 238–257.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2014). Return on investment of apprenticeship systems for enterprises. *IZA Journal of Labor Policy*, *3*(25), 1–22.

Kriechel, B., Muehlemann, S., Pfeifer, H., & Schütte, M. (2014). Works councils, collective bargaining and apprenticeship training. *Industrial Relations*, *53*(2), 199–222.

Muehlemann, S. (2014). Training participation of internationalized firms: Establishment-level evidence for Germany. *Empirical Research in Vocational Education and Training*, *6*(1), Article 5.

Muehlemann, S., Ryan, P., & Wolter, S. C. (2013). Monopsony power, pay structure and training. *Industrial and Labor Relations Review*, *66*(5), 1095–1112.

Muehlemann, S., Braendli, R., & Wolter, S. C. (2013). Invest in the best or compensate the weak? An empirical analysis of the heterogeneity of a firm's provision of human capital. *Evidence-based HRM*, *1*(1), 80–95.

Blatter, M., Muehlemann, S., & Schenker, S. (2012). The costs of hiring skilled workers. *European Economic Review*, *56*(1), 20–35.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2011). Firm-sponsored training and poaching externalities in regional labor markets. *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, *41*(6), 560–570.

Muehlemann, S., Pfeifer, H., Walden, G., Wenzelmann, F., & Wolter, S. C. (2010). The financing of apprenticeship training in the light of labor market regulations. *Labour Economics*, *17*(5), 799–809.

Muehlemann, S., Wolter, S. C., & Wueest, A. (2009). Apprenticeship training and the business cycle. *Empirical Research in Vocational Education and Training*, *1*(2), 173–186.

Muehlemann, S., Pfeifer, H., Walden, G., Wenzelmann, F., & Wolter, S. C. (2009). Cost and benefit of apprenticeship training: A comparison of Germany and Switzerland. *Applied Economics Quarterly*, *55*(1), 7–37.

Dionisius, R., Muehlemann, S., Pfeifer, H., Schönfeld, G., Walden, G., Wenzelmann, F., & Wolter, S. C. (2009). Ausbildung aus Produktions- oder Investitionsinteresse? Einschätzungen von Betrieben in Deutschland und der Schweiz. *Zeitschrift für Berufs- und Wirtschaftspädagogik*, *105*(2), 267–284.

Muehlemann, S., Schweri, J., Winkelmann, R., & Wolter, S. C. (2007). An empirical analysis of the decision to train apprentices. *Labour*, *21*(3), 419–441.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2007). Regional effects on employer-provided training: Evidence from apprenticeship training in Switzerland. *Zeitschrift für ArbeitsmarktForschung*, *40*(2–3), 135–147.

Wolter, S. C., Muehlemann, S., & Schweri, J. (2006). Why some firms train apprentices and many others do not. *German Economic Review*, *7*(3), 249–264.

Handbook Articles & Encyclopedia Entries

Muehlemann, S. (2025). Supply and demand shocks in apprenticeship markets and the role of institutions. In P. Róbert & E. Saar (Eds.), *Handbook on Education and the Labour Market*. Edward Elgar Publishing.

Muehlemann, S., & Pfeifer, H. (2023). Evaluating apprenticeship training programs for firms. *IZA World of Labor*, 506.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2021). Business cycles and apprenticeships. *Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Economics and Finance*. Oxford University Press.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2020). The economics of vocational training. In S. Bradley & C. Green (Eds.), *Economics of Education* (2nd ed.). Elsevier.

Muehlemann, S. (2019). Measuring performance in VET and the employer's decision to invest in workplace training. In L. Unwin & D. Guile (Eds.), *Wiley Handbook on Vocational Education and Training* (pp. 187–206). Wiley Blackwell.

Book Contributions

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2009). Vale la pena di formare apprendisti. In G. Ghisla & L. Bonoli (Eds.), *Lavoro e formazione professionale: nuove sfide. Situazione nella Svizzera italiana e prospettive future* (pp. 203–237). Casagrande.

Muehlemann, S., Wolter, S. C., Fuhrer, M., & Wüest, A. (2007). *Lehrlingsausbildung – ökonomisch betrachtet*. Rüegger Verlag.

Muehlemann, S., Schweri, J., & Wolter, S. C. (2007). Warum einige Firmen Lehrlinge ausbilden – viele aber nicht. In M. Chaponnière et al. (Eds.), *Bildung und Beschäftigung – Beiträge der internationalen Konferenz in Bern* (pp. 317–330). Rüegger Verlag.

Schweri, J., Muehlemann, S., Pescio, Y., Walther, B., Wolter, S. C., & Zürcher, L. (2003). *Kosten und Nutzen der Lehrlingsausbildung aus der Sicht Schweizer Betriebe*. Rüegger Verlag.

Policy Publications & Reports

Muehlemann, S. (2026). KI in Betrieben: Mehr Ausbildung – aber Weiterbildung zunehmend für anspruchsvollere Tätigkeiten. *ifo Schnelldienst*, *79*(3), 9–13.

Muehlemann, S. (2023). Übergang von der Schule in die Berufs(bildungs)welt: Alles besser in der Schweiz? *ifo Schnelldienst*, *76*(12).

Muehlemann, S. (2021). The impact of COVID-19 on apprenticeship markets. *EENEE Ad hoc Report* 1/2021. European Commission.

Muehlemann, S., Pfeifer, H., & Wittek, B. (2020). Auswirkungen der Coronakrise auf den Ausbildungsstellenmarkt: Was die Politik tun kann. *ifo Schnelldienst*, *73*(9), 19–22.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2020). Ausbildung ökonomisch betrachtet: Sieben Lektionen zu Kosten und Nutzen beruflicher Bildung aus Sicht von Unternehmen. Bertelsmann Stiftung.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2019). The economics of apprenticeship training: Seven lessons learned from cost-benefit surveys and simulations. J.P. Morgan Foundation & Bertelsmann Stiftung.

Muehlemann, S., Wolter, S. C., & Joho, E. (2018). Apprenticeship training in Italy – a cost-effective model for firms? New Skills at Work: J.P. Morgan, Fondazione Giacomo Brodolini & Bertelsmann Stiftung.

Muehlemann, S. (2016). The costs and benefits of work-based learning. *OECD Education Working Papers*, No. 143. OECD Publishing.

Muehlemann, S. (2016). Making apprenticeships profitable for firms and apprentices: The Swiss model. *Challenge*, *59*(5), 390–404.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2015). Lehrlingsausbildungen nach Schweizer Vorbild als Weg aus der Jugendarbeitslosigkeit für Spanien. *Die Volkswirtschaft*, 12/2015.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2013). Return on investment of apprenticeship systems for enterprises: Evidence from cost-benefit analyses. *EENEE Analytical Report* No. 16. European Commission.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2013). Personenfreizügigkeit dämpft den Fachkräftemangel in der Schweiz. *Die Volkswirtschaft*, 6/2013.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2011). Vollkommener Wettbewerb auf dem Schweizer Arbeitsmarkt? *Die Volkswirtschaft*, 3/2011.

Muehlemann, S., Wolter, S. C., & Fuhrer, M. (2009). Schulische Qualifikationen von Auszubildenden und das Ausbildungsverhalten der Betriebe. *Wirtschaft und Beruf*, 12/2009, 20–21.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2009). Ausgebliebene Krise auf dem Schweizer Lehrstellenmarkt. *Neue Zürcher Zeitung*, 14 October 2009, 30.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2007). Lehrlingsausbildung lohnt sich. *Die Volkswirtschaft*, 10/2007.

Muehlemann, S., & Wolter, S. C. (2007). Bildungsqualität, demographischer Wandel, Struktur der Arbeitsmärkte und die Bereitschaft von Unternehmen, Lehrstellen anzubieten. *Wirtschaftspolitische Blätter*, 1/2007, 57–72.

Muehlemann, S., Schweri, J., & Wolter, S. C. (2004). Warum Betriebe keine Lehrlinge ausbilden – und was man dagegen tun könnte. *Die Volkswirtschaft*, 9/2004.

Keynotes and Policy Transfer Activities

- Second International Leading House Conference, University of Zurich: Keynote on cost-benefit analyses of apprenticeship training (2024)
- Keynote on productivity effects of workplace training, delivered to delegation from University of Rosario, Colombian government, and business representatives, Munich (2022)
- Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ): Expert in webinar on TVET private sector participation (2020)
- BIBB / IAB Conference: Keynote on why German firms invest in apprenticeship training (2020)

- European Vocational Skills Week, European Commission: Keynote on Italian apprenticeship models, event organized by Fondazione Giacomo Brodolini, JP Morgan & Bertelsmann, Milan (2018)
- International Labour Organisation (ILO): Experts Meeting, Geneva (2017)
- OECD Workshops: Presentations on measuring costs/benefits and VET regulations, Bern (2016)
- Swiss State Secretariat for Education, Research and Innovation (SBFI): Keynote on quality and cost-effectiveness in apprenticeship training, Bern (2015)
- European Business Forum on Vocational Training: Roundtable, European Commission, Brussels (2014)
- Global Cities Education Network: Presentation on the Swiss VET system, Melbourne (2014)

Research Grants and Policy Consulting

- Hans-Böckler-Foundation: Research grant "Quality of work-based training in firms," joint with BIBB (2016–2018)
- OECD: Contract for adult skills, policy reviews, and insights from PIAAC (2017–2018)
- OECD: Intellectual services relative to work-based learning (2015–2016)
- Bertelsmann Foundation: Research grant "Apprenticeship training in Spain" (2014–2015)
- Swiss Federal Office for Professional Education and Technology: Research grant "The impact of internationalization on labor market-oriented education" (2011–2013)
- Swiss National Science Foundation: Short research visit grant, King's College London (2009)
- Leading House Best Paper Award: 1st Prize (2011, 2013, 2015, 2016); Runner-up (2010, 2012, 2014, 2018)

Teaching Experience

PhD Level

Quantitative Methods, MBR (Master of Business Research), LMU Munich (2020–); *Apprenticeship Training: Institutions and Markets*, Swiss Leading House VPET-ECON, University of Zurich (2018, 2019, 2022, 2024, 2026); *Workshop in Human Capital Theory*, LMU Munich (2015).

Graduate Level (Master)

Empirical Methods in Human Resource Education and Management, LMU Munich (2015–); *Evidence-based Human Resource Development* (until 2024: *Advanced Human Resource Development*), LMU Munich (2015–); *Managing Education and Training in Firms/for Firms*, University of Zurich (2015–); *Political Economy of Vocational Education*, LMU Munich (2025); *Human Resource Development: A Global Perspective*, LMU Munich (2021, 2022); *Recent Topics in Human Resource Development*, LMU Munich (2017–2020); *Selected Topics in Human Resource Education and Management*, LMU Munich (2014); *Recent Topics in Economics of Education and Personnel Economics*, University of Bern (2010–2011); *Labour Economics*, SFIVET (2010).

Undergraduate Level (Bachelor)

Institutionen und Berufsbildungspolitik HRE&M III, LMU Munich (2014–); *Economics of Personnel and Training*, University of Bern (2010–2011).

Professional Service: Refereeing

Annals of Public and Cooperative Economics, Applied Economics Quarterly, The B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis & Policy, British Journal of Industrial Relations, Economics of Education Review, Education Economics, Empirical Economics, Empirical Research in Vocational Education and Training, European

Journal of Political Economy, Evidence-based HRM, German Journal of Human Resource Management, IZA Journal of Labor Economics, Human Resource Management Journal, Industrial and Labor Relations Review, Industrial Relations, International Journal of Manpower, Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Journal for Labour Market Research, Journal of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Labor Economics, Journal of Human Resources, Journal of Regional Science, Labour Economics, LABOUR, Oxford Economic Papers, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Regional Studies, Scandinavian Journal of Economics, Schmalenbach Business Review, Scottish Journal of Political Economy, Socio-Economic Review, Swiss Journal of Economics and Statistics.